Music 103 Midterm — What to Memorize

Oct 6, 2026 · @Michael J

Everything to memorize for the Oct 16, 2026 midterm, on one page. Now includes the Week 6.2 and 6.3 slides. Record labels marked † come from discographies, not the slides.

0. Night-Before Cram Sheet

Start here tonight. The exam is all multiple choice, so the goal is to **recognise and tell apart**, not to recall word for word. Cover the right-hand side and test yourself.

A. The 20 songs as one timeline

Say each line out loud while the song plays: *artist — year — label — why it matters*.

Era	Song — artist	Year	Label	Why, in five words
Tin Pan Alley	"You'd Be Surprised" — Billy Murray	c. 1919–20	OKeh	Irving Berlin song, Tin Pan Alley form
Hillbilly	"The Prisoner's Song" — Vernon Dalhart	1924	Victor †	Million-selling "hillbilly" record
Depression country	"No Depression in Heaven" — Carter Family	1936	Decca †	Rural Depression; "Carter style" guitar
Delta blues	"Sweet Home Chicago" — Robert Johnson	1936/37	Vocalion †	AAB 12-bar; crossroads myth
Swing	"One O'Clock Jump" — Count Basie	1937	Decca †	Big-band riff style, no vocal
Gospel	"Strange Things Happening Every Day" — Sister Rosetta Tharpe	1944/45	Decca †	Gospel crossover; electric guitar first
Honky-tonk	"Your Cheatin' Heart" — Hank Williams	1952/53	MGM †	Steel guitar, fiddle, raw voice
Chicago blues	"Hoochie Coochie Man" — Muddy Waters	1954	Chess †	Electric band; stop-time riff

Era	Song — artist	Year	Label	Why, in five words
Rock 'n' roll	"That's All Right" — Elvis	1954	Sun	First record; Crudup original; trio
Rock 'n' roll	"Maybellene" — Chuck Berry	1955	Chess †	From "Ida Red" (country); cars
Rock 'n' roll	"Hound Dog" — Elvis	1956	RCA Victor	Big Mama Thornton's song; TV scandal
Soul	"What'd I Say" — Ray Charles	1959	Atlantic	Gospel + R&B = soul
Teen pop	"The Twist" — Chubby Checker	1960	Parkway †	Hank Ballard song; Dick Clark; No. 1 twice
Nashville Sound	"I Fall to Pieces" — Patsy Cline	1961	Decca †	Smooth country-pop crossover
Girl group	"Be My Baby" — Ronettes	1963	Philles	Spector's Wall of Sound
Surf	"Surfin' U.S.A." — Beach Boys	1963	Capitol	Berry's "Sweet Little Sixteen"; credit
Folk rock	"Subterranean Homesick Blues" — Dylan	1965	Columbia	Folk goes electric; Beat lyrics
Studio pop	"Wouldn't It Be Nice" — Beach Boys	1966	Capitol	*Pet Sounds*; studio as instrument
Motown	"You Keep Me Hangin' On" — Supremes	1966	Motown	HDH + Funk Brothers; Morse-code guitar
Soul	"Respect" — Aretha Franklin	1967	Atlantic	Otis Redding song; feminist anthem

† = label from discographies, not the slides.

B. Labels in groups

- **Decca ×4:** Basie, Carter Family, Tharpe, Patsy Cline †

- **Chess (Chicago) ×2:** Muddy Waters, Chuck Berry †
- **Atlantic ×2:** Ray Charles, Aretha Franklin
- **Capitol ×2:** both Beach Boys songs
- **Elvis: Sun → RCA Victor:** "That's All Right" on Sun, "Hound Dog" on RCA
- **One each:** OKeh (Murray), Victor (Dalhart), Vocalion (Johnson), MGM (Hank), Parkway (Twist), **Philles (Spector → Ronettes)**, **Columbia (Dylan)**, **Motown (Supremes)**

C. Pairs you could mix up

If you hear…	It's…	Not…
Scratchy old record, comic vaudeville voice	Billy Murray	Dalhart (sad, plaintive ballad)
Group harmony over picked acoustic guitar	Carter Family	Hank Williams (one male voice + steel guitar)
Steel guitar, raw male voice	Hank Williams	Patsy Cline (smooth female voice, backing choir)
One man, one acoustic guitar	Robert Johnson	Muddy Waters (electric band, harmonica, stop-time)
Big band, horns, **no singing**	Count Basie	— the only instrumental
1940s gospel lyric + electric guitar solo	Rosetta Tharpe	Ray Charles (electric piano riff, "hey / ho")
Small trio, no drums	"That's All Right"	"Hound Dog" (loud drums, backing vocals)
Berry-style guitar intro, **one voice**	"Maybellene"	"Surfin' U.S.A." (same kind of intro but **stacked harmonies**)
"Boom, boom-boom, CRACK" drum intro	"Be My Baby"	"You Keep Me Hangin' On" (Morse-code guitar pulse)
Surf lyrics, simple harmonies	"Surfin' U.S.A." (1963)	"Wouldn't It Be Nice" (1966: chiming intro, orchestral layers)
Rapid half-spoken words, harmonica	Dylan	—

If you hear…	It's…	Not…
Woman's power gospel vocal, spelled-out chorus	"Respect"	—

D. Exam tactics

- Identify the song first, then answer its 5 questions using table A.
- Cross out the joke option and the off-by-decades year. Look-alike names (Scott vs. Janis Joplin) are deliberate traps.
- "Why it matters" answers are usually *it exemplifies a style* or one of the five arguments in §6, not an obscure fact.
- Before choosing "All of the above," check every option.

E. Tonight and tomorrow

1. **18:15–19:30** Play the 20 songs in the order of table A, saying each row aloud.
2. **19:45–20:30** Labels (B) and confusable pairs (C): play the pairs back to back.
3. **20:30–21:30** §3 People and §4 Terms, covering the right column. Spend extra time on Week 6.
4. **21:30–22:00** Blind test: shuffle and name each song within 10 seconds. Write down the misses.
5. **22:00–22:30** Replay the misses, read §6, then stop. Sleep before 23:30.
6. **Tomorrow morning:** blind test again, the 15 practice questions in the Study Guide, skim §5 and §7. Bring an HB pencil and your ONEcard.

1. The 20 Songs

The exam asks **artist, year, label, significance** for each. Labels marked † are from discographies, not the slides — check against Brackett if you can.

#	Song	Artist	Year	Label	Why it matters	Hear it by
1	You'd Be Surprised	**Billy Murray** (written by Irving Berlin)	c. 1919–20	OKeh	Tin Pan Alley song form: intro → vamp → verses → chorus	Tinny old recording, comic vocal

#	Song	Artist	Year	Label	Why it matters	Hear it by
2	One O'Clock Jump	Count Basie	1937	Decca †	Swing era; 12-bar blues instrumental; Basie's "riff style"; band's theme song	No vocal; horn sections trading riffs
3	The Prisoner's Song	Vernon Dalhart	1924	Victor †	Cost 7¢, sold millions; marketed as "hillbilly"; "folk — of the people"	Plaintive solo vocal, sparse backing
4	No Depression in Heaven	The Carter Family	1936	Decca †	Rural Appalachian experience of the Depression; Maybelle's thumb-picking "Carter style"	Group harmony over picked acoustic guitar
5	Sweet Home Chicago	Robert Johnson	1936/37	Vocalion †	Delta blues; textbook AAB 12-bar; crossroads myth	One voice, one acoustic guitar
6	Hoochie Coochie Man	Muddy Waters (written by Willie Dixon)	1954	Chess †	Chicago blues standard: electric, full band, stop time, call & response	Stop-time riff; harmonica
7	Your Cheatin' Heart	Hank Williams	1952/53	MGM †	Honky-tonk: steel guitar, fiddle, nasal vocal, small band	Male, raw, steel guitar
8	I Fall to Pieces	Patsy Cline	1961	Decca †	Nashville Sound: yodel removed, Jordanaires, studio musicians; country/pop crossover	Female, smooth, faint backing choir
9	Strange Things Happening Every Day	Sister Rosetta Tharpe	1944/45	Decca †	First big gospel/race-records crossover; electric guitar as lead before rock 'n' roll	Gospel lyric + electric guitar solo
10	What'd I Say	Ray Charles	1959	Atlantic	Crystallised soul; melisma; call & response with Raelettes; Parts 1 & 2; banned by some stations	Electric piano riff; "hey / ho"

#	Song	Artist	Year	Label	Why it matters	Hear it by
11	Maybellene	Chuck Berry	1955	Chess †	From Bob Wills's "Ida Red" (country); car-culture teen story; writer-performer-guitarist	Fast; Cadillac vs Ford lyric
12	That's All Right	Elvis Presley	1954	Sun	First record; Sam Phillips; Arthur Crudup original (1946); trio; rockabilly	Three players, no drums
13	Hound Dog	Elvis Presley	1956	RCA Victor	Transformed Big Mama Thornton's 1952 hit; Milton Berle TV scandal, "Elvis the Pelvis"	Loud drums, backing vocals
14	The Twist	Chubby Checker	1960	Parkway †	Written by Hank Ballard (1959); No. 1 in 1960 *and* 1962; dance craze; Dick Clark	Dance instructions in lyric
15	Be My Baby	The Ronettes	1963	Philles	Greenwich, Barry, Spector; Wall of Sound; Gold Star Studios; Hal Blaine	Drum intro: boom, boom-boom, CRACK
16	Surfin' U.S.A.	The Beach Boys	1963	Capitol	From Berry's "Sweet Little Sixteen" → songwriting credit; Brian Wilson; "California Sound"	Berry guitar intro; harmonies, falsetto
17	Wouldn't It Be Nice	The Beach Boys	1966	Capitol	*Pet Sounds* single; orchestral Wall of Sound; key change; overdubbed voices; Wrecking Crew	Chiming intro; dense layers
18	Subterranean Homesick Blues	Bob Dylan	1965	Columbia	On *Bringing It All Back Home*; rock 'n' roll beat + surreal, Beat-poet lyrics; seen as a threat to the folk movement	Rapid half-spoken vocal, harmonica

#	Song	Artist	Year	Label	Why it matters	Hear it by
19	You Keep Me Hangin' On	The Supremes	1966	Motown	Written/produced by HDH, played by the Funk Brothers; multitrack, Wall of Sound influence; covered by Vanilla Fudge	Morse-code / radio-broadcast guitar part; Diana Ross lead
20	Respect	Aretha Franklin	1967	Atlantic	Otis Redding original (1965); produced by Jerry Wexler; feminist symbol; changing Black racial self-consciousness	"R-E-S-P-E-C-T"; gospel power vocal

Also from the review sheet's sample question: Scott Joplin, "Maple Leaf Rag" — copyrighted **1899**; exemplifies the ragtime sound.

2. Dates and Numbers

The instructor said exact years matter less than knowing the **decade and what was happening**. These are the ones that recur.

When	What	Week
late 1800s	Tin Pan Alley; publishers at the centre of the business	2
1880	**45,000 pianos** manufactured; sheet music **30–40¢** a copy	2
1899	Joplin, "Maple Leaf Rag" (ragtime)	2
1909	**Copyright Act** → royalties on recordings, called **"mechanicals"**	2
1911	Berlin, "Alexander's Ragtime Band" (popularised by Emma Carus)	2
1921	Recorded-music revenue peaks at **$106 million**	2
1922	Paul Whiteman ft. Henry Busse, "Hot Lips"	2

When	What	Week
1923	Bessie Smith, "Down Hearted Blues" — Black artists reach a national audience	2
1925	**Grand Ole Opry** begins on **WSM**, Nashville	3
1928/29	Pinetop Smith, "Pinetop's Boogie Woogie"	4
1932	Rickenbacker makes the first electric guitars	4
1933	Revenue falls to **$6 million** (radio + Great Depression)	2
mid-1930s – early 1940s	**Swing era**	2
1938	**Electrified instruments** appear in country, western, R&B	3/4
1939	Billboard **"hillbilly"** chart; Opry picked up by **NBC** (national)	3
1943	Opry moves to the **Ryman**; Muddy Waters arrives in Chicago	3
WWII	Shellac and vinylite rationed — record production pauses	3
1945	Chart renamed **"American Folk"**. Frith: modern industry "in place" by 1945	1/3
1949	Billboard **"Country and Western"** *and* **"Rhythm and Blues"** — both renamed the same year	3
1949	Jimmy Preston, "Rock the Joint"	4
1950 / 1952 / 1954	Telecaster / Les Paul / Stratocaster	4
1952	Haley, "Rock the Joint"; Thornton, "Hound Dog"; *American Bandstand* begins (to 1989)	4/5
1954	Haley, "Rock Around the Clock"; Elvis on **Sun**; Ray Charles, "I Got a Woman"; Muddy Waters, "Hoochie Coochie Man"	3/4
1955	Rock 'n' roll marketed to an **interracial teenage market**; "Maybellene"; "Tutti Frutti"	4

When	What	Week
1956	Elvis to **RCA ($35,000)**; "Heartbreak Hotel" Top 5 on **three charts**; "Hound Dog"; press moral panic	4
1957–58	Nashville Sound begins	3
Feb 3, 1959	**The Day the Music Died** — Holly, Valens, the Big Bopper	5
1959	"What'd I Say" — soul crystallises; **Berry Gordy founds Motown** (Detroit)	3/4/6
May 9, 1960	**Alan Freed indicted** for accepting **$2,500** (FTC: ~250 DJs took payola)	5
1960	"The Twist"; Shirelles, "Will You Love Me Tomorrow" (first U.S. No. 1 by an all-girl group)	5
1961–63	**Girl groups** peak	5
1961	Patsy Cline, "I Fall to Pieces"; Dylan arrives in Greenwich Village (debut album *Bob Dylan*, Columbia, 1962)	3/6
1963	"Be My Baby"; "Surfin' U.S.A."; Dylan, "Blowin' in the Wind"	5/6
1964	Brian Wilson stops touring; Animals, "House of the Rising Sun"; Sam Cooke, "A Change Is Gonna Come"	6
1965	Byrds, "Mr. Tambourine Man" (Columbia); *Bringing It All Back Home*; "Like a Rolling Stone"; **Dylan plugs in at Newport** (Butterfield Blues Band, "Maggie's Farm")	6
1966	*Pet Sounds*; "Wouldn't It Be Nice"; "You Keep Me Hangin' On"	6
1967	Aretha, "Respect" (Atlantic, produced by Jerry Wexler); HDH royalty dispute with Gordy	6
1972	Motown moves from Detroit to Los Angeles	6

3. People

One line each — what the exam is likely to pair with the name.

Week 2 — Tin Pan Alley, jazz, hillbilly, race records

Who	Remember
Irving Berlin	Born Israel Baline, Russia 1888; New York 1893; collaborative Tin Pan Alley songwriting; the 4-part song form
Scott Joplin	"Maple Leaf Rag" (1899); ragtime = syncopated African American piano music tied to European marches
Jelly Roll Morton	"Black Bottom Stomp" (1925/26); **hot jazz**; ragtime-influenced composition
Paul Whiteman	"**King of Jazz**" because jazz was equated with **sweet dance music**; symphonic + jazz; excluded Black artists
Louis Armstrong	1901–1971, New Orleans; trumpet + voice; Hot Five, "Muskrat Ramble" (1926); solo performance; later a crossover example
Count Basie	1904–1984; started in Harlem; orchestra 1935/36; riff style
Vernon Dalhart	"The Prisoner's Song" (1924): 7¢ to make, millions sold, "hillbilly"
The Carter Family	"No Depression in Heaven" (1936); influence on bluegrass, country, rock, pop
Bessie Smith	"**Empress of Blues**"; 1894–1937, Tennessee; Columbia; Classic Blues

Week 3 — R&B and country

Who	Remember
Jack L. Cooper	1888–1970; **first African American DJ**

Who	Remember
Robert Johnson	1911–1938, Mississippi; Delta blues; crossroads myth; "Cross Road Blues" (1936) → Cream's "Crossroads" (1966)
Muddy Waters	1913–1983, Mississippi; to Chicago 1943; "**father of modern Chicago blues**"; electrified
T-Bone Walker	1910–1975, Texas; influenced B.B. King; "did the splits without missing a beat"; "Stormy Monday" (1947)
Bob Wills	Texas Playboys; **Western Swing**; "New San Antonio Rose"; "Ida Red"
Hank Williams	1923–1953, Alabama; honky-tonk; Opry member; lonely figure
Patsy Cline	Nashville Sound; yodel taken out; Jordanaires
Sister Rosetta Tharpe	1915–1973, Arkansas; gospel + electric lead guitar; under-credited (woman; filed as gospel)
Ray Charles	1930–2004, Georgia; gospel + secular lyrics + R&B; "I Got a Woman" (1954) from "It Must Be Jesus"; Atlantic; "High Priest of Soul"

Week 4 — rock 'n' roll

Who	Remember
Bill Haley	Came from Western Swing; "Rock Around the Clock" (1954) — film + timing made it the hit
Jimmy Preston	"Rock the Joint" (1949) — the forgotten original
Chuck Berry	b. 1926, St. Louis; guitarist-songwriter-singer in one; teenage lyrics; guitar as a thing to dance with
Little Richard	b. 1932, Georgia; gospel voice + piano; foregrounded the backbeat; makeup so adults thought him "harmless"
Willie Mae "Big Mama" Thornton	1926–1984; "Hound Dog" (1952), ~2 million copies

Who	Remember
Elvis Presley	1935–1977, Memphis; Pentecostal church; Sun 1954 → RCA 1956; "King" title critiqued; teen idol; celebrity culture
Sam Phillips	Sun Records, Memphis; found Elvis
Alan Freed	DJ; *Moon Dog House*; played Black artists; **integrated** concerts; ended by payola

Week 5 — television, Brill Building, girl groups

Who	Remember
Dick Clark	*American Bandstand*; **all-white** audiences; owned 3 labels, 6 publishers; played "Sixteen Candles" 27× in 3 months; survived payola
Chubby Checker	"The Twist" — Hank Ballard's song
Carole King & Gerry Goffin	"Will You Love Me Tomorrow," "The Loco-Motion"
Phil Spector	**Wall of Sound**; producer as auteur; "widely celebrated" (in scare quotes) — imbalance of power
Darlene Love	Actually sang "He's a Rebel," credited to the Crystals
Hal Blaine	Drummer on "Be My Baby"
The Wrecking Crew	L.A. session musicians behind Spector, *Pet Sounds* and the Byrds

Week 6 — surf, folk rock, Motown, soul

Who	Remember
The Ventures / Dick Dale	Instrumental surf: "Walk, Don't Run" / "Misirlou"
Brian Wilson	Stopped touring 1964; *Pet Sounds* (1966); studio as instrument; "Brian Wilson's puppets?"

Who	Remember
The Byrds	"Mr. Tambourine Man" (1965, Columbia); 12-string Rickenbacker; "folk rock" named by the press
Bob Dylan	Greenwich Village 1961; Columbia contract after a Robert Shelton *NYT* review; Guthrie influence; abstract protest songs; electric at Newport 1965
Berry Gordy	Founded Motown, Detroit 1959, modelled on the assembly line; most successful Black-owned U.S. business by the mid-60s
Aretha Franklin	b. 1942, Memphis; gospel roots; "Queen of Soul"; Atlantic; political engagement, growing Black middle class
Ronald Cohen	Five characteristics of folk
Woody Guthrie	1912–1967; added social commentary and protest to pop; "This Land Is Your Land" (1944/45); Dylan's model
Pete Seeger	1919–2014; union support (1930s–40s); Communist Party member; influential politically and musically
Barbara Dane	b. 1927; anti-war coffeehouse circuit; "I Hate the Capitalist System" (1973, Paredon/Folkways)
Butterfield Blues Band	Backed Dylan's electric set at Newport 1965
Sam Cooke	"A Change Is Gonna Come" (1964): soul as narrative of Black America
Holland–Dozier–Holland	Defined the Motown sound; 25 No. 1s, 1962–67; 1967 royalty dispute with Gordy
The Funk Brothers	Motown's session band (cf. Wrecking Crew, Nashville A-Team)
Otis Redding	Stax artist; first released "Respect" (1965)
Jerry Wexler	Atlantic producer of Aretha's "Respect" (1967)

4. Terms and Definitions

Week 1

Term	Definition
Four key themes	Art vs commerce; industry; technology; identity (+ history)
Subjectivity	"The condition of being a subject" — having perspectives, experiences, feelings, beliefs, desires, power (Brabazon)
Popular music (3 parts)	Has currency beyond a local audience; gains new audiences, meanings and contexts; shapes our identity
"Popular"	Often implies inferiority, "material of the masses"; high vs low culture — but the boundaries are fluid
Sonic elements	Rhythm (beat), melody, harmony, voice, riffs, hooks, lyrics
"Golden"	HUNTR/X, *KPop Demon Hunters*: summer hit, No. 1, and an example of **changing metrics for measuring listenership**

Week 2

Term	Definition
Commodification	Turning music into a product to sell — Frith's "music-as-commodity"
Mechanicals	Royalties from recorded music ("mechanical reproduction"), from the 1909 Copyright Act
Hot jazz vs sweet dance music	Oral, improvised, small combos (Armstrong, Morton) vs written, high-society orchestras (Whiteman)
Canonized	What critics later counted as "real" jazz — the hot combos, not Whiteman

Term	Definition
Cultural appropriation	Movement of ideas, music, language and identities; a **political concern** when **empowered** groups take over attributes of **less powerful** communities
Cultural imperialism	A one-way power relationship of economic and social dominance
Hillbilly / race records	Industry categories for rural white / African American audiences, developed outside Tin Pan Alley
Earlier names for hillbilly	"Old time music" (OKeh), "old familiar tunes" (Columbia), "songs from Dixie" (Brunswick)
OKeh numbering	**14000 Race Series** (Black artists), **15000 Hillbilly Series** (white artists)
Location recording	"Take a recording outfit into the territory where such songs grow"
Great Migration	African Americans moving South → North; labels see a large market
Classic Blues	Vaudeville + field hollers/work songs + call and response; professional, travelling; many performers **women**

Week 3

Term	Definition
DJ	"An individual who was jockeying or riding a record toward success"
12-bar blues	AAB: two repeated lines + a resolving third; 4/4; chords I–IV–V
Three periods of blues	1920s–40s Delta (acoustic); 1940s–50s Chicago & Memphis (electric); 1960s–70s rock covers
Rhythm and Blues (1949)	Billboard term for all Black secular popular music

Term	Definition
Honky-tonk	Rural Southern bar music: steel guitar, fiddle, nasal vocals, working-class themes
Western Swing	Fiddle string band + big band swing; declined after the war (cost of big bands)
Crossover	Success in more than one market — genres, radio formats, or racial categories
Nashville Sound	Late-50s polish: twang and yodel removed, background singers, studio musicians (Nashville A-Team)
Opry + radio	WSM → NBC: how country became national

Week 4

Term	Definition
Rock 'n' roll (1955)	New form of R&B **marketed to an interracial teenage market**; "language, rhythm and ideology of a generation"
Boogie woogie	Rolling repeated bass figure (piano left hand / bass)
Backbeat	Emphasis on beats **2 and 4** — tells people where to dance
Lead vs rhythm guitar	Melody and solos vs chordal pacing
Pickup	Magnet + coil that turns string vibration into a signal
Rockabilly	Fast country mixed with R&B (early Elvis)
Melisma	One syllable sung over several notes (Ray Charles)
Stop time	The band stops so the voice is exposed
Juxtaposing vs synthesizing	Presley's voice puts styles side by side rather than blending them

Term	Definition
Moral panic	1956 press: "communicable disease," "cannibalistic and tribalistic," juvenile delinquency

Week 5

Term	Definition
Payola	"Pay" + "Victrola": paying DJs to play records; break-out cities
Teen pop	Pleased **both** teens and politicians; brought back separate songwriter / instrumentalist / singer roles
Pre-sold market	Clark's television audience, ready to be sold records
Music video	Visual and sonic literacies; texts of excess; advertisement. MTV didn't invent sound + vision
Brill Building	Broadway & 49th; sound = R&B, Latin, gospel; approach = **control** of the industry, **replaceable performers**
Girl groups	Singers, not instrumentalists; finite careers; fashion; first wide representation of **female subjectivity** (Brabazon)
Production line	Singers at the bottom; producers pick from the talent pool, often for little pay
Wall of Sound	Dense, reverberant; many instruments playing the same part; made for AM radio and jukeboxes

Week 6

Term	Definition
Surf music	Southern California; initially **instrumental**, trebly electric guitar

Term	Definition
Beach Boys sound	Contrapuntal, falsetto-led vocals; multipart harmony; "Chuck Berry riffs"; beach and middle-class teen lyrics
California Sound	Wilson's production; later the Byrds' more ambitious version
Concept album	*Pet Sounds* — an album as one connected work
Studio experimentation	Overdubbing, mixing, looping, unusual instruments, theremin
Folk rock	Traditional folk + rock instrumentation; British Invasion + urban folk revival; **term coined by the U.S. press for the Byrds**
Motown	Black-owned Detroit label (Berry Gordy, 1959); assembly-line model; moved to L.A. in 1972
Folk (Cohen's five)	Regional/cultural origin; unknown authorship; non-professional performers; simple communal composition; oral transmission
Folk debates	Left vs. right; authenticity vs. change; preservation vs. transformation
Newport 1965	Dylan's first plugged-in live set ("defection"); purists objected to electric guitar, a rock 'n' roll band, and playing a single
Electric folk	Made the guitar central to the rock decade; shifted sound vs. noise and lyric vs. rhythm
Soul music	Distinct 1960s genre, cuts ties with 1950s R&B; "Southern" = ideology of disconnection, displacement, narratives of Black America
Stax vs. Motown	Memphis, down-home Southern soul vs. Detroit, smooth "uptown" Northern soul
Motown Sound	"Sweet"/pop (Supremes) to funk (Junior Walker); tambourine on backbeat; strings, horns, background vocals; KISS

5. Quotes to Recognise

You won't have to write these out, but a multiple-choice question may quote one and ask who said it or what it means.

Quote (short form)	Source	Point
"The contrast between music-as-expression and music-as-commodity defines twentieth-century pop experience"	Frith, 231	Art vs commerce
The music industry "determines what songs, singers and performances are and can be"	Frith, 232	Industry shapes music, not just sells it
"By 1945 the basic structure of the modern music industry was in place"	Frith, 236	Records as commodities, a few large companies
"The tether between listening choices and constructing a sense of self establishes boundaries of belonging…"	Brabazon	Listening builds identity and in/out groups
"Popular music becomes part of the shared experiences of a group or community…"	Brabazon	Definition of popular music
"Falling back to the default setting of lyrical analysis, political resistance and masculine authenticity"	Brabazon, 40	What weak music writing does
"Take a recording outfit into the territory where such songs grow"	Brackett	Hillbilly location recording
"A blues-based music that used jazz elements…for an urban, African American audience"	Brackett	Definition of R&B

Quote (short form)	Source	Point
"Rock 'n' roll was also music that the teenagers were able to play themselves…my music is more serious"	Ray Charles (Brackett)	Soul vs rock 'n' roll
"Maybe a little faster, but basically it was country"	Chuck Berry (Brackett)	"Ida Red" → "Maybellene"
"We decided that my image should be crazy and way-out so that the adults would think I was harmless"	Little Richard (Brackett)	Image as strategy across a racial barrier
"Not so much synthesizing preexisting styles as juxtaposing them"	Brackett, 111	Presley's voice
"Pop music history is built on flash-in-the-pan fads"	Breihan, 20	On "The Twist"
"The one man that the committee had always been gunning for was Dick Clark"	*Life*	Payola hearings
"Brian Wilson's puppets?"	*Melody Maker*, 1966	Who is the author of a Beach Boys record?
"…a few booed their once-and-former idol"	Brackett, 156	Newport 1965: the crowd split over electric Dylan

6. The Five Arguments Behind Most "Significance" Answers

Most "why does this song matter?" questions come back to one of these. Learn the argument once, then plug in the song.

1. Genres are categories the industry made up. "Hillbilly" and "race records" were marketing labels. Labels created separate series for them (OKeh 14000/15000), and the charts had separate names that changed over time (race → rhythm & blues). The categories followed race and region more than the musical sound. *Use for:* Mamie Smith, Fiddlin' John Carson, Jimmie Rodgers, Robert Johnson, Hank Williams.

2. Who got credit and who got paid. Black artists created styles, and white artists or songwriters often profited from them through cover versions, borrowed songs and white-owned labels. Examples include Pat Boone's covers of Little Richard, the history of "Hound Dog" (Big Mama Thornton before Elvis), and the hidden studio musicians and writers behind hit records. *Use for:* Little Richard, Big Mama Thornton / Elvis, Chuck Berry, Ray Charles, girl groups, Motown.

3. Crossover. A song or artist moves from one chart or audience to another, usually from R&B or country to the pop charts. Crossover meant bigger sales, but it often meant toning down the music or the image. *Use for:* Chuck Berry ("basically it was country"), Elvis (black and white styles side by side), Ray Charles, the Supremes, Little Richard's "harmless" image.

4. Who controls the music. Over the period, power moves from the publisher and the song (Tin Pan Alley), to the performer and the record, to the DJ (Alan Freed, payola), to the TV host (Dick Clark), and finally to the producer and songwriter team (Brill Building, Phil Spector, Brian Wilson, Berry Gordy). *Use for:* Tin Pan Alley, payola, "The Twist," the Wall of Sound, "Brian Wilson's puppets?", Motown.

5. Authenticity, gender and image. Who counts as "real": the rural singer, the bluesman, the folk singer with a guitar versus the manufactured teen idol or girl group. These judgments usually favour male authorship and dismiss music made by women or by producers as fake or trivial (Brabazon's warning about "masculine authenticity"). *Use for:* Robert Johnson myth, girl groups, Dylan going electric at Newport (folk purists vs. the electric guitar), Aretha's "Respect" (a woman's voice demanding respect).

Bonus: technology changes the music. Sheet music → phonograph → electrical recording and the microphone (crooning) → radio → the 45 and the jukebox → TV → studio as instrument (Wall of Sound, *Pet Sounds*). If a question asks "how" a sound became possible, start here.

How to write a significance answer (2–3 sentences)

1. Name the song, artist and year.
2. Say which argument above it shows.
3. Give one concrete detail from class (a label, a chart, a quote, a sound you can hear).

7. Week 6 Readings: Facts to Know

Reading	Remember
Leight, "Good Vibrations" (*Billboard*)	Released Oct. 1966, **No. 1 in Dec. 1966**; the Beach Boys' **first million-seller** and the last of Brian Wilson's three No. 1s. **Recorded in fragments across several L.A. studios and pieced together** ("vast jigsaw puzzle"). **Electro-Theremin**; cello as a rock instrument; Hal Blaine on drums; cost $10k–$50k. Wilson wanted "modern, avant-garde R&B." Mike Love called it "truly radical" and wrote the lyrics. **Left off *Pet Sounds*** (which peaked at No. 10) because Brian, as producer, decided. Followed by the abandoned *Smile* and the end of the band's commercial dominance
Breihan, "I Want to Hold Your Hand" (*The Number Ones*)	U.S. release Dec. 26, 1963, **No. 1 Feb. 1, 1964**, on **Capitol** (EMI) after earlier flops on **Vee-Jay** and **Swan (Dick Clark's label)**. **Ed Sullivan: 73 million viewers. Whole top 5** in April 1964. George Martin let them record their own songs. Pop influences: Aldon, girl groups, Everlys, Buddy Holly. Arrived after JFK's assassination. "Imperial phase." **20 No. 1s.** British Invasion: Animals, Manfred Mann covering a Brill Building song that had flopped for a Black girl group. Self-written songs become the norm (Monkees vs. Kirshner)

The Beatles aren't on the review sheet, so the Breihan chapter is lower priority than "Good Vibrations."